João Blasques

Business Operations — organized, runs things end to end, uses AI as a daily working method.

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SUMMARY

I turn mess into process, and process into automation. The organizing has always fallen to me: running my own contracts across four countries — travel, equipment, vendors, documentation, safety; data-quality gates that fail the build instead of writing a report nobody reads. The approach for a growing company: buy the right tools, write the process before automating it, keep a human check at the step that matters.

"AI-enabled" in practice: an agent-operated development workflow (Claude Code, CLI-first), and production systems I built with one hard rule — nothing leaves without human approval. For operations that means Microsoft 365, off-the-shelf finance and CRM, written SOPs, and AI where it saves hours.

Background: software and data since 2002, wind-turbine blade repair offshore, freelance data engineering since 2023. No payroll or HR titles; what I bring is operating discipline, order, and AI applied with the human at the final step.

EXPERIENCE

Blade Repair Technician — various contracts (Muehlhan Wind, GEV Wind Power, Bladefence, Global Wind Service) — Apr 2021 – Dec 2024 Offshore and onshore wind farms in Sweden, Norway, Greece, and Germany, on Vestas and Siemens Gamesa/GE turbines. Each contract was also a small operation to run myself: travel, equipment, vendors, documentation and safety across four countries. Technical: leading-edge protection and overlamination repair, uptower upgrades, de-icing and lightning-protection commissioning, rope-access inspection. The final contract (Global Wind Service, Feb – Dec 2024) overlapped with the freelance data work below — that was the transition before data engineering became full-time.

Web Developer / GIS Analyst / Project Manager — Universidade Nova de Lisboa — 2009 – Apr 2013 Lisbon, Portugal. Ran web development projects end to end — project management, analysis, design, implementation, and monitoring. GIS data analysis on spatial datasets, alongside the GeoSpatial Technologies master's at NOVA IMS.

Data Engineer — DataStuff.nl (freelance) — Oct 2023 – Present Remote, part-time/freelance. I build governed lakehouses on Databricks and GCP: medallion architecture, dbt transformations and tests, Great Expectations data-quality gates wired into CI, Spark Structured Streaming, Terraform with keyless (WIF) CI. Proof of what I do with AI and automation under controls. Public showcase: Vitals and MBTA.

Information Technology Engineer — European Commission, Joint Research Centre — Feb 2002 – Feb 2003 Italy. Web programming, database management, and project implementation.

EDUCATION

- **Master's degree, GeoSpatial Technologies** — NOVA IMS Information Management School (2010 – 2012)
- **Bachelor's degree, Environmental Engineering Technology** — Universidade Nova de Lisboa (1995 – 2001)

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Databricks Fundamentals** — Databricks (issued Jun 2025)
- **Data Engineer in Python** — DataCamp (issued Feb 2025)
- **Associate Data Engineer in SQL** — DataCamp (issued Jan 2025)

SKILLS

Three tiers, each backed by something I've actually shipped and can point to. Full detail with per-skill evidence links: joaoblasques.com/skills. I'm not claiming anything below at a depth the public work doesn't support.

Core — use daily, will defend in depth: Python, SQL · Databricks (Unity Catalog, Delta, Asset Bundles, serverless Jobs, Lakeflow/DLT) · Lakehouse design (medallion, policy-in-gold) · dbt · Data-quality gates (Great Expectations + dbt tests in CI) · CI/CD & IaC (GitHub Actions, Terraform, keyless WIF/OIDC) · Cost discipline (DBU attribution, budget alerts)

Working — shipped with it, still deepening: Spark Structured Streaming (Auto Loader, Kafka) · GCP data stack (BigQuery — external tables, partitioning, clustering, cost tuning · GCS · Pub/Sub · Cloud Run · Cloud Scheduler) · Airflow · Dimensional modelling (star schema) · Feast feature store · pgvector / embeddings · MLflow · Agentic/LLM pipeline patterns · Docker

Familiar — used, not claiming depth: DuckDB & Postgres · Azure/AWS fundamentals · Kubernetes basics · Scala/Java (read comfortably) · Tableau/PowerBI basics

BEYOND WORK

I volunteer time and skills where they're useful — disaster-relief work (2004 Indian Ocean tsunami, Tamil Nadu) and long-term social projects in India and the Philippines.